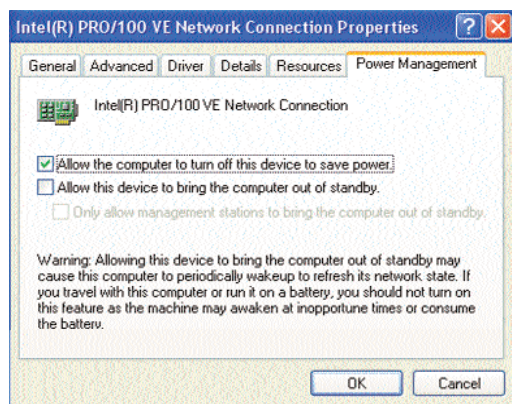


Before starting the data recovery process, make sure the drive on which you intend to dump the recovered data is larger than the one from which you are recovering data!

Stop Waking Me Up

Q My system configuration is an AMD Athlon XP 2200+, 384 MB of RAM, a Gigabyte motherboard, a D-Link 56 Kbps Modem and a Compact UPS. I use dial-up. Sometimes I forget to switch off the UPS after shutting down the system. Whenever I receive a call, the system starts up! Why?

K Hemanth Kumar



Change Power Management settings of your LAN card

A You have a setting enabled in the BIOS which you don't want. Switch off "Wake on Modem" and "Wake on LAN", both of which you'll find under the Power Management section of the BIOS.

If your PC shows such behaviour in Sleep/Standby mode, click on **Start > Run**, type "devmgmt.msc" and hit [Enter]. Right-click on the installed modem and click Properties. Click the Power Management tab and uncheck the box next to "Allow this device to bring the computer out of standby", and click OK.

Memory Muddles

Q I want to buy the best RAM for my server/graphics workstation. I have to choose between DDR2 667 and DDR PC 3200. Which is superior and how? Is any other kind of RAM superior?

Satyajit Patnaik

A DDR2 667 MHz is definitely better than DDR PC 3200 from an upgradeability point of view. The frequency of the RAM can be calculated by dividing the value after the "PC" by 8. Thus PC 3200 is 400 MHz, and has a slower clock speed than the 667 MHz DDR2.

But there are other factors that need to be considered. DDR2 memory, which operates at a higher frequency, also has higher latency than DDR, so the performance gain over DDR is not as great as you might expect taking the price into consideration.

In any case, before you buy any RAM at all, you must check whether your motherboard supports it. At present, DDR2 667 MHz

memory is a better choice for you, but these are not readily available in the Indian market, whereas 533 MHz DDR2 is easily available.

Questions Galore

Q I have a Pentium 4 3.2 GHz, an Intel 915GV motherboard, 512 MB of DDR2 400 MHz RAM, and NEC ND-3530A and LG GSA-4163B DVD-Writers. I have 12x CD-RW media, to which I am able to write at only 10x using either drive. Why? Both the drives support writing to CD-RWs at much higher speeds.

Also, is it possible to add 533 MHz DDR2 RAM to my PC? What is the maximum hard drive capacity and the "highest" processor my motherboard supports?

S Sudhakar

A That's a lot of questions! Well, the speed at which a CD/DVD-Writer writes to a CD-RW depends not only on the media and the drive, but also on the table of media types that is built into the firmware of the writer. The drive tries to recognise the blank media inserted, and matches it with the list in its table to decide the speed. It also reads the speed certified by the media manufacturer, and if these don't match, the writer decides to use a safer, lower speed.

Another reason could be that the writer does not support the intermediate speed of 12x—for example, it may support 10x, with the next supported speed being 16x.

Your motherboard supports IDE as well as SATA hard drives of the highest capacities available. You cannot add more RAM running at a different frequency, but you can certainly replace your present RAM with 533 MHz DDR2. It supports any Intel processor with the LGA775 socket interface barring dual-core processors.

Clean That Jukebox

Q I have a 20 GB MP3 player called a "Jukebox." It has a problem: when I switch on the Jukebox, I get this error: "Hard disk error. No valid FAT 16/32 found. Please format the hard disk." I tried to format it, but when the format was about to complete, a message popped up: "Windows was unable to complete the format."

Mandeep Singh Vaseer

A Download the format utility for your MP3 player from the manufacturer's Web site. This will let you format the hard drive.

Leave My Office Alone

Q I have Microsoft Office 2003 installed on my Windows XP PC. I also have Norton Antivirus 2004 installed. The problem is that whenever I try to open any Office file, it pauses to scan the file using the anti-virus program, and then proceeds to open the file. I am only using Office files that I created, so there's no need for a virus scan. The virus scan takes place even when I disable the anti-virus in the system tray. Is there a way to disable the scan?

Anuj Malhotra